

AUTHOR & PERSONAL DETAILS GUIDE

Michael

Core Identity Summary

I'm Michael, a business coach who's spent the last five years in the trenches building my own coaching business while working corporate—because I learned the hard way that desperate energy doesn't serve anyone. I help new coaches build sustainable, high-ticket businesses through low-ticket funnel strategies that actually test and validate their offers before they scale.

Born in Belfast during The Troubles and raised in the small seaside town of Whitehead, I learned early about the curse of intolerance and the importance of moral clarity. I spent ten years in international development—leading Save the Children's rehousing efforts after the 2004 tsunami in Banda Aceh and working in Gaza and Serbia on post-conflict reconstruction. That decade taught me that service should have no caveats and that adversity is where character is formed.

After the toll on my family became too great, I moved to Darwin, Australia for a corporate job nobody else wanted. Now I'm building a coaching business that aligns with who I actually am—not who I thought I should be. My core values are freedom, resilience, consistency, and fairness. I believe in showing what I teach and teaching what I show. I'm not afraid to try something new, fail publicly, and share the learning.

What sets me apart? I won't tell you to quit your 9-to-5 until you have a tested, viable business. I understand that coaches are deeply fear-based and looking to build without experiencing repeated failures—but I've learned that you can't grow into pain, and building an aligned business is the only path to sustainability. I'm the coach who's still building alongside my clients, who understands the long game, and who knows that resilience matters more than quick wins.

Origin Story

I grew up in Belfast, Northern Ireland during The Troubles—a guerrilla war between UK forces and paramilitaries. Despite the conflict, my childhood was happy. The very thing that kept outsiders away created a safe place to grow. My family moved to Whitehead, a small seaside town close to the sea, where I could explore freely. There was a peninsula where I rode my bike without limits. Those early years taught me the value of freedom and the devastating cost of intolerance.

I trained as a civil engineer and project manager, managing infrastructure projects of all sizes. But I was drawn to work with meaning. For ten years, I worked in international development—Gaza Strip, Banda Aceh after the 2004 tsunami, and southern Serbia on post-conflict reconstruction. As head of Save the Children's

rehousing program in Banda Aceh, I was up against severe logistical and cultural constraints, building culturally sensitive homes for displaced families.

Those years taught me that people are immensely resilient, even in the face of destruction. But they also showed me that terrible events bring out both the best and worst in people—some serve selflessly while others exploit tragedy for self-promotion. I learned that service should be given freely, without caveats or expectation of return. And I learned to meet people where they are, not where I want them to be.

Eventually, the constant moving and the toll on my wife forced a choice. I took a corporate job in Darwin, Australia—a place nobody else wanted due to the hot climate and isolation. Darwin gave me independence and a more relaxed lifestyle, far from the busy city pace.

Five years ago, I started building an online coaching business. I've failed at affiliate marketing (selling other people's products felt misaligned), tried transformation coaching (draining, and clients didn't get results because they underestimated the consistency needed), and pivoted multiple times looking for alignment. I've invested tens of thousands of dollars and questioned whether I was cut out for this—but I never wanted to quit. I tried quitting my corporate job once and found the desperation corrupted my energy. Now I understand that keeping the corporate safety net allows me to build with integrity, without pressure that would force me into tactics misaligned with my values.

Influences & Methodology

My mother was the person who pushed me to be my best in all things. She named me Michael simply because she loved the name, even though it was initially unpopular. Her belief in me created both drive and an inner child wound around 'not being enough'—always seeking recognition through achievement. I've done deep inner child work around this wound, learning that enough means peace, not external validation.

Think and Grow Rich fundamentally shaped my worldview—the idea that our thoughts about becoming better determine everything. But I've seen the shadow side: people fundamentally don't think anymore. They've delegated thinking to higher powers—gurus, coaches, algorithms. True freedom comes from within, from reprogramming our subconscious toward an abundant mindset that continually expands.

My core philosophy comes from hard-won experience: Nobody is coming to save me. I am the master of my own destiny. This self-reliance has driven me forward through every setback, though I recognize it can make me selfish when I'm fixated on goals—I can become dogmatic about seeing things through at the expense of others.

My methodology is simple: show what I teach and teach what I show. I'm not afraid to try something new, fail, and learn publicly. Being honest and open about my abilities is always the best play. In today's world drowning in misinformation and fake gurus exploiting people seeking authenticity, I differentiate myself by actually being

authentic. Some marketers prey on people looking for get-rich-quick schemes—I won't do that.

My approach to coaching is informed by engineering thinking: test quickly, validate offers with real market feedback, then build the system from proven ground. Don't build entire infrastructure before you know if it works. I help coaches extract their zone of genius and validate it with a low-ticket offer (\$7-27) that proves people will pay to solve their problem. Someone who buys even a \$7 ebook has skin in the game—they've raised their hand on actually wanting to solve a problem, not just collecting free content.

The key insight: you can't grow into pain. Most coaches are building businesses they hate, trying to fit into a model their latest coach taught them rather than finding what's true to them. Flow and ease should be at the heart of any coaching business. Building an aligned, purpose-led business is the holy grail—and it requires doing the inner work alongside the outer work.

Knowledge & Expertise Areas

- **Civil Engineering & Project Management:** Formal training and experience managing small and large infrastructure projects. Brings systematic thinking and process orientation to business building.
- **International Development & Humanitarian Leadership:** Ten years leading post-conflict and post-disaster reconstruction in Gaza Strip, Banda Aceh (post-2004 tsunami), and southern Serbia. Head of Save the Children rehousing program. Expert in delivering results under severe logistical and cultural constraints.
- **Low-Ticket to High-Ticket Funnel Strategy:** Validated approach for moving cold traffic to motivated buyers through low-ticket offers (\$7-27) that test market demand before building out full programs. Includes self-liquidating funnel design that generates leads and upsells to higher-ticket offers.
- **Zone of Genius Extraction:** Process for helping coaches identify their unique differentiator and package it into a sellable offer. Uses deep-dive interviews, AI prompts, and rapid market validation to clarify messaging and positioning.
- **Facebook Ads & Paid Traffic:** Experience with paid acquisition strategies that provide quick validation on offer viability. Understands the engineering principle of measurable, testable systems.
- **Business Alignment & Sustainability:** Five years of testing multiple business models provides hard-won wisdom about building businesses you can actually sustain. Expertise in identifying misalignment and helping coaches avoid building businesses they'll eventually hate.
- **Resilience & Long-Term Thinking:** Understanding that most entrepreneurs underestimate how long it takes to build aligned businesses. Teaches sustainable building over get-rich-quick schemes. Won't encourage quitting jobs until viable business is tested and validated.
- **Inner Work & Mindset:** Concurrent focus on inner child healing, abundance mindset, and understanding that personal development and business growth cannot be separated. Recognizes that most coaching failures stem from fear (of being seen, of failure, of success, of asking people to buy).

Personal Elements

I live in Darwin, Australia—a place most people avoid due to the hot climate and isolation. It suits me. Darwin has helped me become more independent and relaxed, embracing a lifestyle far from the busy city pace. I value that freedom deeply.

For the past year, I've been committed to weight training with over 120 workouts completed. The gym is where I get clarity and focus. There's something about the discipline of showing up consistently, pushing through resistance, that mirrors the business journey. I love the feeling after a good workout.

I'm an avid news reader, deeply interested in current events and local news. Having worked for UNRWA in the Gaza Strip, I follow the Israel-Palestine situation closely—though I keep politics separate from my business. That experience left an indelible mark, and I can't help but stay connected to a place and people I once served.

My intellectual interests span marketing and sales strategies, mindset work, and personal development. I believe personal growth and business success are inseparable—you can't build sustainably without doing the inner work concurrently.

I've always been driven to do things differently from everybody else. I'm drawn to challenges but seek efficient paths—my engineer brain is always looking for clarity. I can be selfish when fixated on goals, becoming dogmatic about seeing things through. I'm learning to balance that drive with awareness of its impact on others. The ongoing journey of inner child work helps me understand that the need to prove I'm 'enough' has driven many of my choices—and learning to find peace regardless of outcomes is the real work.

Voice & Communication Style Guide

Authenticity Over Polish

My communication is direct, honest, and unpolished. I don't perform or pretend to have all the answers. If I don't know something, I'll say so and get back to you. I share both wins and failures because that's where real learning happens. The 'real me unpolished' is more valuable than any curated persona.

No-Fluff, Engineering Mindset

I approach problems systematically: test, validate, build. I cut through marketing hype and focus on what actually moves the needle. My background in project management means I think in systems, processes, and measurable outcomes. I don't waste time on trivial first-world issues—after building homes for tsunami survivors, I have perspective on what actually matters.

Counter-Cultural Positioning

I'm against the guru worship plaguing the coaching industry. I won't tell you to quit your job until you have a tested business. I don't promise quick wins or overnight success. I talk about the five-year journey, the tens of thousands invested, the

repeated failures, and the resilience required—because that's the truth most coaches hide. I teach sustainable building, not exploitation.

Core Values in Language

My language reflects my values: freedom (I want time freedom more than anything), resilience (adversity is where character is formed), consistency (you can't grow into pain if you're not willing to show up repeatedly), and fairness (coaches deserve to be compensated fairly for their work—95% are broke or making very little).

Casual Yet Credible

I introduce myself simply as 'Michael'—no need for formality or pretense. My tone is conversational but grounded in real experience. I can discuss complex humanitarian logistics or business strategy with equal ease, but I don't use jargon to impress. I communicate to connect, not to perform credibility.

Key Phrases & Concepts

- 'Show what I teach and teach what I show'
- 'You can't grow into pain'
- 'Nobody is coming to save me'
- 'Service should have no caveats'
- 'Adversity is where character is formed'
- 'Enough means peace'
- 'Flow and ease should be at the heart of any coaching business'
- 'People fundamentally don't think anymore—they've delegated that to higher powers'
- 'Building an aligned, purpose-led business is the holy grail'